

Here's the revised plan. The big structural change: **no more standalone Bible search block.** Each search now lives inside the teaching segment where it belongs.

Session 20: Celebrating Lent and Holy Week

60-Minute Lesson Plan — OLV PSR Grade 3

Theme: Lent and Holy Week are times to think of how we treat others.

Materials: Bibles (one per kid or shared), board/markers for scorekeeping, paper and pencils for intercessions, printed Jeopardy grid (or draw on board)

Setup before kids arrive: Write team names and score columns on the board. Have intercession paper ready to hand out fast.

OPENING (~2 min)

[0:00–0:02]

Split the class into 2–3 teams as kids sit down. Assign by table or row — don't let them pick.

Say: "Bibles out. Today we've got four Bible searches, a lesson, and Jeopardy at the end. Same teams the whole time. Every point counts — Bible search points carry into Jeopardy. So pay attention."

Bible Search Rules (say once, enforce all class):

- First team where EVERY member has a finger on the right page gets the point.
 - Help your teammates by pointing — no shouting page numbers across the room.
-

SEGMENT 1: SEARCH + THE SAMARITAN WOMAN + LENT INTRO (~12 min)

[0:02–0:14]

Bible Search 1 — John 4:5–15

Say: "First search. This is about Jesus doing something no one expected — talking to a stranger everyone told him to avoid. Find **John, chapter 4, verse 5.**"

Kids search. First complete team gets 1 point.

Say: "Winning team — one person read verse 7 out loud."

Jesus said to her, "Give me a drink."

Ask: "True or false — it was totally normal for Jesus to talk to this woman." **(False.)**

Say: "Not even close. Let me tell you the whole story."

Storytelling Script: The Samaritan Woman

"So picture this. Jesus has been walking all day. It's hot. He's tired, he's thirsty, and he sits down next to a well — like a big stone water fountain.

A woman walks up to get water. She's a Samaritan. Now here's the thing — Jewish people and Samaritan people did NOT get along. They didn't talk to each other. They didn't share cups or plates. It was like two groups at school who refuse to sit at the same lunch table.

And on top of that, men weren't supposed to talk to women they didn't know. So everything about this situation says: Jesus should ignore her.

But what does Jesus do? He says, 'Can I have a drink?'

The woman is shocked. She says, 'You're Jewish. I'm Samaritan. Why are you talking to me?'

And Jesus says something amazing. He says, 'If you knew who I was, YOU would be asking ME for a drink — because I can give you living water that means you'll never be thirsty again.'

He wasn't talking about regular water. He was talking about God's love. And the woman went back to her whole village and told everyone about Jesus. She became one of the first people to spread the word about him — and she wasn't even Jewish."

Ask: "How many rules did Jesus break in that story — 1, 2, or 3?" **(At least 2 — talking to a Samaritan, talking to a woman he didn't know. Accept 3 if someone says drinking from her cup.)**

Ask: "Raise your hand if you've ever been the new kid somewhere — new school, new team, new neighborhood." (Hands go up.)

Bridge to Lent

Say: "That story is read during Lent every year. And here's why — Lent is the 40 days before Easter. It starts on Ash Wednesday. And the whole point of Lent is to look at how we treat other people. Jesus looked at a woman everyone said to ignore — and he treated her like family. That's what Lent asks us to do."

SEGMENT 2: LENT VOCABULARY (~5 min)

[0:14–0:19]

Say: "Lent has three big practices. I'm going to teach you all three plus one more word, and then we're doing a speed round."

Write on the board as you go:

1. **ALMSGIVING** — "Alms-giving. Say it with me." (Class repeats.) "It means sharing your money, your time, or your stuff to help someone who needs it."
2. **FASTING** — "Fasting means giving something up. Literally, it means not eating. But it can also mean giving up screen time, candy, something you like — so you understand what it feels like to go without."
3. **PRAYER** — "Not just talking to God — but specifically praying for OTHER people and their needs."
4. **INTERCESSION** — "An intercession is a prayer asking God to help someone else. Not you — someone else."

Say: "Speed round. Teams ready? First team to answer gets the point."

- "How many days is Lent?" **(40)**
- "What day does Lent start?" **(Ash Wednesday)**
- "What are the three practices of Lent?" **(Almsgiving, fasting, prayer)**
- "Giving money or time to help others is called ____." **(Almsgiving)**
- "Giving something up so you understand what it's like to go without is called ____." **(Fasting)**
- "What color does the priest wear during Lent — red, green, or purple?" **(Purple)**

Track points on the board.

SEGMENT 3: SEARCH + THE WIDOW'S OFFERING + ALMSGIVING (~8 min)

[0:19–0:27]

Bible Search 2 — Luke 21:1–4

Say: "Bibles back up. We just learned the word almsgiving. This next verse is the best story in the Bible about what almsgiving really means. Find **Luke, chapter 21, verse 1.**"

Kids search. First complete team gets 1 point.

Say: "Winning team — read verses 1 through 4 out loud together."

Ask: "The widow put in two small coins. Was that A) just her spare change, or B) everything she had?" **(B)**

Say: "Right. Now let me tell you why that matters."

Storytelling Script: The Widow's Offering

"Jesus is sitting near the Temple — the big church building — watching people put money into the collection box. Rich people are walking up and dropping in bags of coins. Clink, clink, clink. Big show. Everyone can see how much they're giving.

Then this poor widow walks up. She puts in two tiny coins. The smallest coins they had. Together they were worth almost nothing.

And Jesus turns to his friends and says: 'You see her? She just gave more than ALL of those rich people.'

His friends are confused. How? The rich people gave way more money.

Jesus says: 'They gave out of their extra. They still have plenty left over. But she gave everything she had to live on. That's real giving.'"

Teaching Moment: What Almsgiving Really Means

Ask: "Was Jesus impressed by A) how much money people gave, or B) how much it cost them to give it?" **(B)**

Ask: "True or false — almsgiving is only about money." (**False — it's also time and resources.**)

Say: "During Lent, we practice almsgiving. You don't need money. You can give your time — help someone carry something, sit with someone who's alone at lunch, do a chore at home without being asked. It's about giving something that costs you something."

SEGMENT 4: SEARCH + TOBIT + OLD TESTAMENT ROOTS (~4 min)

[0:27–0:31]

Bible Search 3 — Tobit 4:7

Say: "This idea of helping the poor didn't start with Jesus. It goes all the way back to the Old Testament. I'm going to send you to a book most of you have never heard of. Find **Tobit, chapter 4, verse 7**. Hint: Tobit is in the Old Testament, after Nehemiah."

This one is harder — give extra time. Award **2 points** to the first complete team (bonus for difficulty).

Winning team reads it aloud:

"Give alms from your possessions. Do not turn your face away from any of the poor, so that God's face will not be turned away from you."

Teaching Moment: God Sees How We Treat People

Ask: "True or false — this verse says it's okay to ignore poor people if you're busy." (**False**)

Say: "Listen to that last part again: 'Do not turn your face away from any of the poor, so that God's face will not be turned away from you.' What's it saying? If you ignore someone who needs help — God notices. If you help someone who needs it — God notices that too."

Ask: "Was this written before Jesus was born, or after?" (**Before — Old Testament.**)

Say: "So this isn't a new idea. God has always asked people to take care of each other. Jesus grew up learning this. And during Lent, we practice it."

SEGMENT 5: SEARCH + FASTING + SERVING OTHERS = SERVING JESUS (~6 min)

[0:31–0:37]

Bible Search 4 — Matthew 25:40

Say: "Last search. This might be the most important thing Jesus ever said — and it's one verse. Find **Matthew, chapter 25, verse 40.**"

Kids search. First complete team gets 1 point.

Winning team reads it aloud:

"Amen, I say to you, whatever you did for one of these least brothers of mine, you did for me."

Teaching Moment: Fasting, the Desert, and Why It All Connects

Say: "Before Easter, Jesus went into the desert for 40 days. That's where we get the 40 days of Lent. In the desert, Jesus fasted — he didn't eat. And he was tempted by the Devil. But he resisted."

Ask: "What does it mean to fast? Is it A) to eat a lot, or B) to not eat — to give something up?"
(B)

Say: "Catholics abstain from meat on Fridays during Lent. Some people give up candy, or screen time, or something they really like. The point isn't to suffer for no reason. The point is — when you give something up, you start to understand what it feels like for people who don't have it at all."

Ask: "Fill in the blank: 'Whatever you did for one of these least brothers of mine, you did for ____.'" (Me / Jesus)

Say: "That's the whole thing. When you help someone who's hungry, lonely, left out, struggling — Jesus says you're helping HIM. Almsgiving, fasting, prayer — they all come back to this. How we treat other people is how we treat Jesus."

SEGMENT 6: INTERCESSIONS — PRAYER OF THE FAITHFUL (~8 min)

[0:37–0:45]

Say: "We've talked about almsgiving and fasting. The third Lenten practice is prayer — and not just any prayer. During Lent, we especially pray for other people. That's what an intercession is."

Ask: "What's the Prayer of the Faithful? Is it A) a prayer just the priest says, or B) a prayer the whole church prays together for the needs of the world?" **(B)**

Say: "At Mass, someone reads a prayer — for the Church, for people who are sick, for our community. And after each one, everyone says together..."

Prompt the class: "Lord, hear our prayer." (Have them say it.)

Activity — Writing Intercessions

Hand out paper (or use workbook page 165 if you have it).

Say: "You're writing two intercessions. One for someone in our community — someone you know, or a group here in Columbus. One for something happening in the world. Two minutes. Write fast."

Format on the board:

For _____, may God _____. Let us pray to the Lord. **Lord, hear our prayer.**

Give them 2 minutes. Walk around, keep them on task.

Then say: "Okay. We're going around the room. Read your intercession out loud. After each one, everyone says: 'Lord, hear our prayer.' This is real — this is what we do at Mass. Let's treat it that way."

Go around the room. After each intercession, class responds: **"Lord, hear our prayer."**

End with: **"Jesus, help us grow during Lent through prayer, fasting, and almsgiving. Amen."**

TRANSITION (~2 min)

[0:45–0:47]

Say: "Before Jeopardy — fast. Fill in the blanks."

- "The three Lenten practices are _____, _____, and _____." **(Almsgiving, fasting, prayer)**
- "A prayer asking God to help someone else is called an _____." **(Intercession)**
- "Lent lasts _____ days and starts on _____." **(40, Ash Wednesday)**

- "When you help others, Jesus says you did it for ____." (**Him / Jesus**)

Say: "Jeopardy. Same teams. Your Bible search points carry over. Let's go."

JEOPARDY (~13 min)

[0:47–1:00]

Same teams. Bible search points carry over. 5 categories x 5 values (100–500). All Jeopardy question tables ready for backfill in the committed file.

Categories 1–3 = Session 20 content (Lent 101, Vocab Words, Scripture Stories). **Categories 4–5** = year review (TBD). **Final Jeopardy** = tie the year together (TBD).

Logistics: Teams alternate picks. 10 seconds to answer. Wrong = steal for half. Final Jeopardy with 2 min left.

TIME BUDGET

Segment	What Happens	Min
Opening	Teams, rules, Bibles out	2
1	Search: John 4 → Samaritan Woman story → Lent intro	12
2	Lent vocabulary teach + speed round	5
3	Search: Luke 21 → Widow's Offering → Almsgiving	8
4	Search: Tobit 4 → Old Testament roots of almsgiving	4
5	Search: Matt 25 → Fasting + serving others = serving Jesus	6
6	Intercessions — write and pray aloud	8
Transition	Review speed round	2
Jeopardy	25 questions + Final	13
	Total	60

LESSON ARC

The four searches follow a deliberate arc:

1. **John 4** — Lent is about how we treat others (Jesus breaks barriers)
2. **Luke 21 + Tobit 4** — We give to others: almsgiving (the widow + OT command)
3. **Matthew 25** — We sacrifice and serve: fasting (what we do for others = for Jesus)
4. Flows into **intercessions**: we pray for others

Each search opens its teaching moment. The verse isn't just found — it's read, explained, and connected to what comes next.